

A day in the app: the Shop Manager

The Shop Manager (Production Manager) owns flow: the right trailers moving through the right stations with the right people, problems surfaced in minutes instead of days, and the numbers honest enough to coach from. On site **Monday–Thursday, 6:00–4:30** — breaks at **9:00** and **2:00** (15 min), unpaid lunch at **11:00** (30 min). The app's job is to make the floor visible; your job is to act on what it shows.

6:00	Stand-Up & the morning huddle — read the band, approve the plan, recognize yesterday's idea
6:20	Run the board — bottleneck first, then the queue, then the floor
9:00	Break (15 min) — glance the inbox on your phone
9:15	Andon & problems — the floor never waits silently
11:00	Lunch (30 min, unpaid)
11:30	QC gates & made parts — Ready is earned, BUILD-NOW parts get scheduled
2:00	Break (15 min)
2:15	Scorecards, SOPs & safety — coach from the drill-down, never the color
3:30	Checkout window — day verification, rank today's ideas, tomorrow's plan
weekly	The idea loop & the Monday numbers — vote Monday, reveal Tuesday, implement always

First: how the app thinks about the floor

Stages drive everything.

When a stage is marked complete — from the board, My Station, or a traveler QR — the machine turns: entering Build assigns VINs, entering Paint queues the federal labels, completing Paint queues the MSO, and each completed stage consumes that stage's materials into WIP value. If stages lag reality, every downstream number lies. Your single most important habit: the board matches the floor before you go home.

Standard hours are the yardstick.

Every model carries a labor routing. Completing a stage earns its standard hours; efficiency = standard earned divided by actual logged. That's what the efficiency card, the red flags, and every scorecard measure. The yardstick self-corrects: time surveys after checkout feed real actuals back into the routings.

WIP limits protect flow (finish before you start).

Each stage has a cap. When a station is over its limit the bottleneck card names it and how long it's been stuck — the answer is to finish and unstick, not to start something new.

Problems are andons, not hallway comments.

Any worker can raise a problem from the traveler QR in ten seconds. It lands in your inbox as "the floor is waiting" — because they are. Resolve it in the app so the blocker Pareto learns what actually stops this shop.

The plan is drafted for you, approved by you.

Generate proposes each person's day from what's scheduled and their demonstrated pace — then it's a proposal until you press Approve. The app does the arithmetic; you do the judgment.

Ideas are anonymous until they win.

Everyone submits one improvement idea at checkout, daily. You rank them without names so merit is the only currency; the author is revealed only when the crew's Monday vote crowns the week's winner. Your end of the deal: implement winners and report back at stand-up.

6:00 — Stand-Up & the morning huddle

WHEN 6:00 • 20 MINUTES • WHERE STAND-UP

- 1 Open Stand-Up. Read your four-card band before anyone talks: Labor efficiency (yesterday's % shop-wide and by station), SOP compliance, Red flags (anyone under threshold with real hours), Bottleneck (any stage over its WIP limit, and for how long).
- 2 Click Generate plan for today. The app proposes tasks per person — calibrated to each worker's demonstrated pace, not wishful standards. Adjust anything that doesn't survive contact with reality, then Approve the day — the crew sees their goals the moment you do.
- 3 Run the huddle at the board (or the TV): today's goal per station, the bottleneck if there is one, and yesterday's winning idea — read it out loud, still anonymous. Tuesday: announce the weekly champion BY NAME.
- 4 Anything you promised to implement from a past winner? Give the ten-second status. The loop only stays credible if the report-back happens.

6:20 — Run the board

WHEN 6:20 • WHERE PRODUCTION FLOW

- 1 Bottleneck first. If the card named a stage, go there physically. "Over for N hours" is your urgency meter. Finish work out of that stage before anything new enters it.
- 2 Then the queue. The Production Queue tab is the build order — resequence with the arrows when priorities change. The floor builds top-down from this list; changing it here is how you re-aim the shop.
- 3 Then the board. Drag orders between stages as reality moves — or better, let the floor stamp stages themselves from My Station or the traveler QR. Every stamp records who and when.
- 4 WIP limits are yours to tune (WIP limits button). Set them to what each station can genuinely hold — a limit that's never hit isn't a limit.

WHAT A STAGE STAMP TRIGGERS

Into Build: VINs auto-assign (federal scheme, NHTSA-checked). Into Paint: VIN stickers queue for the office. Paint complete: MSO queues (stock units hold until sold). Each stage done: that stage's parts consume out of inventory into WIP at actual cost. Into Ready: blocked until QC passes.

9:15 — Andon & problems

WHEN 9:15 (AFTER THE 9:00 BREAK) • WHERE INBOX • TRAVELER QR • PERFORMANCE

- 1 A worker hits a wall — missing part, bad fit, broken tool — and reports it from the traveler QR on their phone. It lands in your Action Inbox as a shop-floor problem: the floor is waiting.

- 2 Go to the trailer, fix or reroute, then resolve the andon in the app with what it was. Minutes matter.
- 3 Weekly, read the blocker Pareto on Performance: the top three reasons, their counts, and hours lost. That list — not memory — is what you fix at the root.

11:30 — QC gates & made parts

WHEN 11:30 (AFTER LUNCH) • WHERE MY STATION (FINISH) • PREDICTIVE ORDERING

QC at the Ready gate

- 1 Nothing reaches Ready until every VIN on the order passes the QC checklist — QC per unit at the Finish station, with photos. The checklist is maintained in Print Center (admin) — the same list for every trailer, on purpose.
- 2 A failed item auto-raises an andon on the order: fix, re-check, then the gate opens. If the board refuses to move an order to Ready, that's the gate doing its job.

Made parts & BUILD NOW

- 1 Your inbox's BUILD NOW line means a made part (weldment, bent metal) will run short before scheduled builds need it. Schedule someone onto it today.
- 2 Made parts get logged as they're produced — Log made parts on Stand-Up → My Station — which keeps made-part stock and the BUILD-NOW math honest.
- 3 Fabricators pull drawings-of-record from the traveler QR → BOM worksheet & cut list (auto-numbered cuts, no dollars). If a cut is wrong, the fix goes in the engineering package, not on a sticky note.

2:15 — Scorecards, SOPs & safety

WHEN 2:15 (AFTER THE 2:00 BREAK) • WHERE STAND-UP • DAILY UPDATE

- 1 Red flags lists anyone under the efficiency threshold today with real hours logged. Open their Daily Scorecard — trailers touched, parts built, tasks, hours vs standard earned, the 7-day trend, and the drill-down of exactly which tasks drove the gap.
- 2 Coach from the drill-down, never the color. A red day with a reason (waited on parts — see the andon log) is a flow problem, yours to fix. A red week without one is a conversation.
- 3 SOP checkpoints: the compliance card tracks today's confirmations (done by the floor at Daily Update). You own the list — add/retire checkpoints as the process changes; a checklist nobody fails has stopped teaching.
- 4 Safety: log findings and incidents the moment you see them — they feed the safety card and "days since incident." Resolve findings when corrected. An unlogged near-miss teaches no one.

3:30 — The checkout window

WHEN 3:30 • CREW CHECKOUT ~4:00-4:30 • WHERE STAND-UP

- 1 Workers finish with the 60-second day verification: confirm hours, reconcile the plan, and submit one improvement idea (required). Some also get a time-check on recent work; encourage honest numbers — they tune the standards everyone is measured against.
- 2 Watch compliance on Stand-Up: whoever hasn't verified by 4:15 gets a nudge in person. Unverified days poison tomorrow's plan math.

- 3 Open the ideas card and rank today's ideas — they're anonymous. Pick today's daily winner before you leave; it's announced at tomorrow's huddle.
- 4 Glance the board one last time: does it match the floor? Stamp anything the crew missed. Generate tomorrow's plan now or at 6:00 — approving it is a morning job.

The weekly rhythm

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	YOUR PART
Every day	Everyone submits an idea at checkout; you pick the daily winner	Rank anonymously, announce at the next huddle
Monday	The crew votes on last week's daily winners (one vote each, no self-votes)	Remind them at the huddle; close voting end of day
Tuesday	The weekly champion is announced BY NAME	Celebrate them at the huddle; commit to an implementation path
Ongoing	Winners move in-progress → implemented with a report-back note	Drive it, and say so at stand-up
Month-end	Weekly winners meet on the monthly ballot; most votes is crowned Idea of the Month by name	Open the vote at the first-Monday huddle, crown the champion
Monday a.m.	The weekly digest email: KPIs vs expectations, recommendations, open problems, throughput	Read it before the huddle — same math as Performance

THE TV AND WHAT THE CREW SEES

Put a wall display in TV mode (button on Performance): it rotates Production Flow → Stand-Up → Performance with live data. The floor should never need to ask "what's the goal today" — it's on the wall, and their phones answer "what's next for me."

WHAT'S DELIBERATELY NOT YOURS

Receiving, invoicing, printing, and QuickBooks live with the office — your stage stamps are what trigger their queues. Team & Payroll, Time Off, Goals, and the Wins wall are staged for a later rollout phase; the ideas loop and scorecards are the recognition system for now. Thursday you're the senior app user on site: keep stages honest and stage arriving freight for Monday's receiving — the carrier saying "delivered" never moves inventory; a staff confirmation does.

Pocket reference

I NEED TO...	GO TO
Read the floor at a glance	Stand-Up → the four-card band
Propose / approve today's plan	Stand-Up → Generate plan → Approve the day
Change the build order	Production Flow → Production Queue → arrows
Set station WIP caps	Production Flow → WIP limits

See / resolve floor problems	Inbox → the order · Pareto on Performance
Pass a trailer to Ready	My Station (Finish) → QC per VIN
Open someone's scorecard	Stand-Up → scorecards (SM can open anyone's)
Rank ideas / announce winners	Stand-Up → ideas card
Log made parts	Stand-Up → My Station → Log made parts
Log a safety finding / incident	Safety log (feeds "days since incident")
Give a fabricator the cut list	Traveler QR → BOM worksheet, or BOMs & Cost → Engineering
Put the shop on the wall	Performance → TV mode

Built Trailers · Shop Manager runbook · reflects the app as deployed. When a screen and this document disagree, trust the screen and tell whoever maintains this document.